PP-C-400B
October 15, 1971
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. PP-C-400A
June 15, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLAMS, CANNED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers canned clams for use by Government agencies where refrigeration is not required.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Species. Canned clam meats shall be prepared from the following species as specified (see 6.1).

(a) Butter clams (Saxidomus nuttalli)

(b) Little-neck clams (Protothaca staminea)

(c) Hard or quahog (Venus mercenaria)

(d) Razor clams (Siliqua patula)

(e) Soft clams (Mya arenaria)

(f) Surf or skimmer (Spisula solidissima) (Atlantic)

(g) Pismo (Tivela stultorum)

1.2.2 Types. Clams shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1).

Type 1 - Whole
Type 2 - Minced - (see table I)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

FSC 8905

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Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-29 - Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing Of.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-668 - Sanitary Standards for Food Plants.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by the supplier in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

United States Public Health Service Publication No. 33, Cooperative Program for the Certification of Interstate Shellfish Shippers. Part I, Sanitation of Shellfish Growing Areas; and Part II, Sanitation of the Harvesting and Processing of Shellfish.

United States Public Health Service Publication No. 956-1962 Public Health Service Drinking Water Standards

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Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, D.C. 20044.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Clams. Clams shall all be strictly fresh and shall have been harvested from approved beds (see item 3, table I). Clams shall be free from any off-odors. This shall include, but not be restricted to, amine, ammonia, stale, kerosene, fuel oil, putrid or sour.

3.1.2 Salt. Salt (sodium chloride) shall be white, refined, with or without anti-caking agents. Iodized salt shall not be used.

3.1.3 Water. Water used for washing the clam meats and equipment, and for use in brine (packing medium) preparation shall comply with U.S. Public Health Publication No. 956-1962 Drinking Water Standards.

3.1.4 Additives. Additives, if used, shall comply with the requirements cited in 3.4 as permitted for canned clams.

3.2 Processing.

3.2.1 The products shall be prepared in accordance with table I, to result in finished products complying with 3.3.

TABLE I. Physical requirements (processing)

Item	Requirement
1	The type 1 product shall be formulated from whole clam meats and filtered clam liquor or 3 percent salt (sodium chloride) brine (see 6.1).
2	The type 2 product shall be formulated from minced or chopped clams and the addition of not more than

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TABLE I. Physical requirements (processing) (cont'd)

Item	Requirement
	1-1/4 percent by weight of net contents of salt (sodium chloride).
3	The whole clams, as received and before washing, shall be freed of all open, broken, or dead clams. The clams, before shucking, shall be washed and all external sand or mud removed. The shucking shall be in accordance with Public Health Service Publication No. 33. Blanching of the clams for one minute in a 1-1/2 percent solution of citric acid is permissable.
4	Minced or chopped clams shall be prepared from whole clams by grinding the washed meats through a plate having holes 1/4 to 1 inch in diameter.
5	The products shall be filled into the can, the can vacuumized (see 5.1), sealed, and heat processed sufficiently to stabilize the product for safe use.

3.3 Finished product (both types). The finished product shall comply with the requirements of table II.

TABLE II. Physical requirements (finished product)

Item	Requirement
1	The product shall be free from foreign odor or flavor which includes, but is not restricted to, an ammonia or amine-like, putrid, stale, musty, sour, kerosene, fuel oil, seaweed, or excessively salty.
2	The product shall be free from any foreign material including, but not restricted to, clam shell, stone, sand, wood, glass, metal, hair, dirt, insect or insect part.
3	The product shall be free from siphon or black membranous tissue, except that the siphon is permitted for hard or

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TABLE II. Physical requirements (finished product) (cont'd)

Item	Requirement
	quahog clams (Venus mercenaria), Little Neck Clams (Protothaca staminea), and surf or skimmer (Spisula solidissima).
4	The product shall be free from a color foreign to the species involved. This shall include, but not be restricted to, red, black, purple, or green color.

3.4 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

3.5 Plant qualification.

3.5.1 General. The clams shall be prepared in plants certified by a state whose control measures have been endorsed by the United States Public Health Service and shall comply with all standards and provisions set forth in U.S. Public Health Service Manual No. 33.

3.5.2 Processing. The product shall be processed in establishments under the continuous inspection of the National Marine Fishery Service, U.S. Department of Commerce meeting the requirement of the shellfish cooperative program, or from an establishment listed in the Directory of Sanitarily Approved Food Establishments for Armed Services Procurement in accordance with MIL-STD-668.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling. Samples of finished product covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished product may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 General. Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing and packaging, at any suitable point in transit, and after delivery to the point of destination.

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4.2.2 Factory inspection. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the supplier of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 Final inspection. Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.4 Responsibility for inspection. The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein, using his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government.

4.2.4.1 Inspection record of the examinations and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2.4.2 Plant qualification conditions. The product furnished under this document shall be unacceptable if not produced and stored in plants which currently meet the qualification conditions of 3.5.

4.2.4.3 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.4.4 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.2.4 above, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards, unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.4.4.1 Examination of water. Examination shall be made to determine that water used in the production of products under this specification is in compliance with 3.1.3. Certified semi-annual laboratory test reports from the state in which the plant is located or of the Federal Government indicating that the water supply conforms to U.S. Public Health Service Drinking Water Standards shall be made available for review. Failure to comply with any of the stated requirements shall be the basis for rejection of the component or of the end item of which the component is a part.

4.2.4.4.2 Examination of salt. Examination shall be made to determine that salt used in the production of products under this specification is in compliance with 3.1.2. Failure to comply with any of the stated requirements shall be the basis for rejection of the component or of the end item of which the component is a part.

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4.2.4.4.3 Testing of brine and citric acid solution, when applicable. Testing of sodium chloride and citric acid solution, when applicable, shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of items 1 and 3 of table I as concerns the percent of citric acid and sodium chloride. Testing shall be made on the inital lot and each subsequent lot. Records shall be maintained. Nonconformance to the above referenced requirement, reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for the rejection of the involved quantity of the product.

4.2.4.5 Process examination. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) examination shall be made during processing to determine compliance with the applicable requirements of table I. Time records, when applicable, shall be maintained. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of product.

4.2.4.6 Examination of end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables IV through VI and 4.2.4.6.1. Examination criteria shall be as shown in table III. AQLs shall be expressed as percent defective for tables IV and V and as defects per hundred units for table VI. Finding of any major A defect shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE III. End item examination criteria

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs Major B	AQLs Minor
IV	S-3	One primary container	Number of primary containers	-	2.5
V	S-3	One primary container	Number of primary containers	-	2.5
VI	1/	Contents of one primary container	Pounds	2.5	6.5

1/ For can size 211 X 400, 300 X 407, 307 X 113, 307 X 202 and 307 X 409, the inspection level shall be level S-3; for can sizes 404 X 700, 502 X 510 and 603 X 700, the inspection level shall be S-2.

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TABLE IV. Examination for net weight 1/ 2/

Category	Defects
Minor	
201	Net weight more than 10 percent under specified weight (container 1 pound or less).
202	Net weight more than 5 percent under specified weight (container more than 1 pound but not more than 10 pounds).

1/ Lot average net weight shall be not less than specified weight. The lot shall be rejected if the sample data indicate a lot average net weight less than that specified (see table VII).

2/ Report weights 1 pound or less to the nearest 1/8 ounce and weights more than 1 pound to the nearest 1/4 ounce.

TABLE V. Examination for drained weight 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Drained weight less than 47 percent of marked net weight.

1/ Percentage of lot average drained weight shall be not less than 48 percent of net weight.

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TABLE VI. Examination of product characteristics

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	
101			Presence of foreign odor or flavor (e.g. an ammonia or amine-like, putrid, stale, musty, sour, kerosene, fuel oil, seaweed or excessively salty).
102			Presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, metal particle, wood, dirt, hair, insect or insect part).
103			Presence of foreign color (e.g. red, black, purple or green).
	151		Presence of stone.
		201	Presence of shell or shell piece.
		202	Presence of sand.
		203	Presence of dark membranous tissue.
		204	Presence of siphon except where permitted (see table II, item 3).

4.2.4.6.1 Examination of packaging, packing, vacuum, labeling and marking. Examination of packaging, packing, vacuum, labeling and marking shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of PPP-C-29. In addition, when examination of the filled and closed shipping container for level A or B pack is in accordance with the examination criteria of the appendix to PPP-B-636 the following defect shall be included in the table of examination: Major: Marking, missing, incorrect or illegible.

4.3 Tests. Test procedures and controls which differ from those specified herein, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance, the supplier will use the test procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the test methods specified herein will govern.

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4.3.1 Chemical analyses. Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists in effect on the date of invitation for bids (see 6.1).

4.3.2 Drained weight. The drained weight of the product shall be determined after the cans and contents have cooled to 75°F. ± 5°. Testing shall be performed as follows: Empty contents of the can onto a screen having not more than 8 meshes to the inch and allow to drain for two minutes. Remove the drained product and weigh. This weight constitutes the drained weight.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, packing, vacuum, labeling and marking shall be in accordance with PPP-C-29 for the levels specified. Fill shall be in accordance with table VII. The filled and sealed can shall have a vacuum of not less than 5 inches of mercury.

TABLE VII. Can sizes and net contents

Can size	Net content, ounces 1/
211 by 400	10
300 by 407	15
307 by 113	6.5
307 by 202	8
307 by 409	20
404 by 700	49
502 by 510	51
603 by 700	96

1/ Drained weight shall be not less than 48 percent of the marked net weight.

6. NOTES

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6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b) Species and type required (see 1.2.1 and 1.2.2).

(c) Whether whole clams are to be filled in clam liquor or brine (see table 1).

(d) When in-process examination is not required by civil agencies (see 4.2.4.5).

(e) When chemical analyses are required (see 4.3.1).

6.2 Supplier's inspection. The supplier shall be required to assure that the product conforms to the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.3 Destination inspection (for civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at a point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for identity, condition, and quantity only.

6.4 Award of contract for the product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 3.5 (also see 4.2.4.2).

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

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Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
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Preparing activity:

Army - GL

CIVIL AGENCIES INTEREST:

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1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
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5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

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7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
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